

Meridian Academy — Placement Policy

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Owner: Career Services | Status: Authoritative for all placement matters

1. Purpose and scope

This document defines what placement support Meridian Academy provides, who qualifies for it, and the precise terms of the Placement Assurance conditional refund product. It applies to all learners enrolled in cohorts starting on or after 1 February 2026.

Meridian Academy does not guarantee employment. Nothing in this document should be read as a promise of a job. We provide structured placement support, and separately we offer a conditional refund product on two programs, subject to strict participation conditions set out in Section 5.

2. Which programs include placement services

Program	Placement support	Placement Assurance eligible
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SEF-101	Yes	No
FSWD-201	Yes	Yes
DSML-301	Yes	Yes
DCE-401	Yes	No
ASD-501	No	No

ASD-501 is a senior specialisation and includes no placement services of any kind.

3. The Placement Readiness Gate

Placement services do not begin when a learner enrolls, and they do not begin when the program ends. They begin when the learner clears the Placement Readiness Gate, referred to throughout as the PRG.

3.1 PRG requirements

A learner clears the PRG on the date all three of the following are simultaneously true:

- (a) Attendance credit of at least 85%. Attending a live session counts as 1.0 credit. Watching the full recording of a missed session within 7 calendar days counts as 0.5 credit. Sessions neither attended live nor watched within 7 days count as zero.
- (b) All six module assessments passed, at the 60% pass mark, in any number of permitted attempts.
- (c) The required number of capstone projects for the program submitted and approved by an

instructor. This is two projects for SEF-101 and DCE-401, and three for FSWD-201 and DSML-301.

3.2 What happens if a learner does not clear the PRG

Learners who do not clear the PRG continue to receive career coaching, résumé review, mock interviews, and access to the learning platform. They are not referred to hiring partners and are not eligible for Placement Assurance. There is no penalty beyond that, and a learner may clear the PRG later and enter placement support at that point.

3.3 PRG audit

PRG status is computed automatically and audited manually by Career Services before the first hiring partner referral. Where the audit finds that attendance or project approval was recorded in error, the PRG date is corrected and the learner is informed in writing within 5 business days.

4. Placement support services

Learners who have cleared the PRG receive the following for 12 months from their PRG clearance date. The window runs from PRG clearance, not from program end date, so a learner who clears the PRG late still receives a full 12-month window.

Résumé and portfolio review, with up to three rounds of written feedback.

Mock interviews: up to eight sessions, comprising technical, system design, and behavioural rounds, conducted by practising engineers.

Hiring partner referrals to companies in the Meridian partner network, matched to the learner's program, experience level, and stated location preference.

Access to the Meridian job board, which lists roles from partner and non-partner companies.

Salary negotiation guidance from a career coach at the offer stage.

Two structured career-strategy sessions, one at PRG clearance and one at the six-month mark.

5. Placement Assurance

Placement Assurance is a conditional refund product, not a job guarantee. It is available only on FSWD-201 and DSML-301.

5.1 What it promises

If an eligible learner who has complied with every condition in Section 5.3 does not receive a qualifying job offer within 12 months of clearing the PRG, Meridian Academy refunds 80% of tuition

actually paid, net of scholarships and discounts, exclusive of GST.

5.2 What counts as a qualifying job offer

A qualifying job offer is a written offer of full-time employment, from a company with at least 25 employees, for a role in software engineering, data science, or a directly adjacent technical discipline, at a location in India or fully remote from India, at an annual cost to company of at least INR 7,00,000.

An internship, a contract engagement shorter than 12 months, an unpaid role, a commission-only role, and an offer from a company in which the learner or an immediate family member holds an ownership interest are all excluded.

5.3 Learner conditions

Placement Assurance applies only if the learner satisfies every one of the following. These conditions are cumulative and are strictly enforced.

- (a) Cleared the PRG within 60 calendar days of the program end date.
- (b) Applied to at least 30 roles referred by Career Services during the 12-month window.
- (c) Attended at least 10 interviews arranged through Career Services. A no-show without at least 24 hours' notice counts against this total as a breach rather than an attendance.
- (d) Did not decline two or more qualifying job offers as defined in Section 5.2. Declining one qualifying offer is permitted; declining a second ends Placement Assurance immediately.
- (e) Maintained a total scholarship discount of 30% of tuition or less. Learners with a stacked scholarship discount above 30% receive full placement support but are not eligible for Placement Assurance.
- (f) Responded to Career Services communications within 5 business days throughout the window.
- (g) Is located in India and legally entitled to work in India. Learners located outside India are not eligible.
- (h) Did not accept employment outside the covered disciplines and then request the refund.

5.4 How to claim

A claim is submitted to placement-claims@meridianacademy.example within 30 calendar days of the end of the 12-month window. Claims received after that deadline are not considered.

The claim must include the learner's application log, interview record, and a written statement.

Career Services verifies the claim against its own records within 15 business days. Where records conflict, the Meridian platform record governs.

Approved refunds are disbursed within 30 business days of approval, following the payment routing rules in the Refund Terms document, MA-REFUND-2026-01. Where tuition was financed, the refund is remitted to the partner NBFC first.

5.5 Interaction with the standard refund policy

Placement Assurance is separate from, and does not extend, the standard refund schedule in MA-REFUND-2026-01. A learner who withdraws from the program is not eligible for Placement Assurance, regardless of how much of the program they completed.

6. Hiring partner network

The Meridian hiring partner network comprises approximately 340 companies as of February 2026, across four segments: venture-funded product startups, mid-market SaaS companies, IT services and consulting firms, and a small number of large product companies.

Partner status is reviewed annually. A partner that makes no hire and conducts no interviews for two consecutive years is removed from the network.

Referrals are matched, not broadcast. Career Services refers a learner to roles matching their program, demonstrated skill level, and stated location preference. A learner may request referral to a specific partner, and Career Services will make the referral where the learner meets the stated role requirements.

7. Reported outcomes

The following figures cover learners who cleared the PRG in the twelve months ending 31 December 2025 and are published for transparency. They are historical and are not a prediction.

Program	PRG clearers	Placed in 12 mo	Median CTC (INR)	Highest CTC (INR)
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SEF-101	1,842	71%	6,40,000	18,00,000
FSWD-201	1,516	78%	9,20,000	31,00,000
DSML-301	938	74%	11,80,000	42,00,000
DCE-401	604	76%	10,40,000	28,00,000

"Placed" means the learner reported accepting a written full-time offer within 12 months of PRG clearance. Figures are self-reported by learners and verified by Career Services against offer letters where the learner supplies one. Approximately 8% of PRG clearers did not respond to

outcome surveys and are excluded from the percentages, which therefore overstate placement rates to an unknown but bounded degree.

Median CTC is the median of reported accepted offers, not of all offers received.

8. Learner obligations during placement

A learner receiving placement support must keep their profile and résumé current, respond to referral communications within 5 business days, attend scheduled interviews or give at least 24 hours' notice, report offers received and accepted within 7 calendar days, and represent their experience and credentials honestly.

Misrepresenting experience, qualifications, or Meridian coursework to a hiring partner is a code of conduct violation. It results in immediate withdrawal of placement services, forfeiture of Placement Assurance, and, where the misrepresentation is material, notification to the affected hiring partner.

9. Suspension and reinstatement of placement services

Placement services are suspended where a learner's payment account is in arrears by more than 30 days, where a code of conduct investigation is open, or where the learner has been unresponsive to Career Services for more than 30 calendar days.

Suspension pauses the 12-month placement window. Reinstatement restarts it with the remaining balance of the window intact. A learner may be reinstated at most twice.

10. Escalation

Placement disputes are escalated to careers-grievance@meridianacademy.example. The Career Services lead responds within 10 business days. Placement Assurance claim rejections may be appealed once, within 15 calendar days of the rejection, to the Head of Career Services, whose decision is final.